

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on:

PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS

Bethel Global Missions
No. 7. 11th March 2024



OUR SUBJECT: PATIENCE

The word **patience** is now translated in many translations as endurance which is probably correct - But I still like the word patience for this word is more commonly used in ordinary daily discourse / conversations and is understood by many more.

It also reflects that factor which we all struggle within our walk with Jesus.

It is something that we know we should all have or aim for but difficult to possess especially in those times that we encounter or experience in our Christian journey.

■ THE GREEK WORD FOR PATIENCE.

- * When the Bible talks about **patience**, it speaks of so much more than simply “enduring,” although there certainly is an element of **endurance** implied. The Greek word usually translated “**patience**” in the New Testament is the word **hupomone**, which means **TO STAY OR TO REMAIN**. When you put these two words together, the Greek word means endurance or **TO STAY UNDER**.

NOTE: -

■ FOR US THERE IS OFTEN AN **INNER CONFLICT** OR **STRUGGLE** BETWEEN **PATIENCE** and **IMPATIENCE**.

- * We desire **patience** but **impatience** seems to be also present and seeking to gain ascendancy.
- * **IMPATIENCE** – IS ALWAYS **DEMANDING** – **demanding** that something be done now.
- * **IMPATIENCE** cannot wait and tends to impulsiveness.
- * **IMPATIENCE** seeks to force its own will and plan – instead of “**remaining under**” – i.e. waiting on God to guide or intervene.
- * **IMPATIENCE** annoys, agitates, and frustrates leading to decisions that have not been properly thought through what the ultimate implications might be.

■ **PATIENCE** IS **NOT PASSIVE** – I.E. DOING NOTHING, even though we often are tempted to think that way.

- * **PASSIVITY** MEANS - The acceptance of what happens, without active response or resistance.
- * SO “**REMAINING UNDER**” (**PATIENCE**) IS NOT TO BE MISTAKEN FOR **PASSIVITY**.

■ **REMAINING UNDER**

- * IS POSITIVELY EXERCISING one's FAITH AND TRUST IN GOD WHILE WAITING FOR GOD TO intervene/ DIRECT.
- * “**REMAINING UNDER**” MEANS THAT WE DON'T **RUN AWAY** NOR **CHANGE OUR MINDS** OR **ABANDON OUR COMMITMENT TO TRUST GOD** FOR HIM TO PROVIDE.
- * **THIS IS OUR POSITION AND STANCE** IN THE MIDST OF ALL WEATHERS, CONDITIONS AND CIRCUMSTANCES.

A GENUINE QUERY

- * if I exercise patience how long do we remain in that position before we act or do something?
- * Is it possible that I might be in danger of remaining in that position too long and become inactive in eventually miss doing something meaningful for God?

■ **A CHANGE IN THINKING IS REQUIRED**

- * **The prevailing thinking of man is that he is bound to the concept that something, some action is better than being patience or waiting.**
- * **But what do we do with the scriptures which repeatedly state to “wait on God”. (which means to trust God and remain in that proactive and positive position)**

■ **THE CHALLENGE FOR US IS ALLOW PATIENCE TO HAVE ITS PERFECT WORK IN OUR LIVES**

James 1:3-4

3 Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.

4 But let patience have her perfect work, that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing. KJV

James 1:4“.. faith having been put to the test for the purpose of being approved, and having met the test, has been approved, [that this approving process] produces a patience which bears up and does not lose heart or courage under trials. But be allowing the aforementioned patience to be having its complete work in order that you may be spiritually mature and complete in every detail, lacking in nothing. Kenneth S. Wuest

- * **PATIENCE POSSESSES OUR SOULS – PATIENCE THAT REACHES TO THE INNERMOST PARTS OF OUR BEING - Luke 21:19 In your patience possess ye your souls. KJV**

- * **PATIENCE WAITS FOR THAT WHICH IS NOT YET SEEN - Romans 8:25 But if we hope for that we see not, then do we with patience wait for it. KJV**

- * **PATIENCE WAITS FOR THAT WHICH IS NOT YET SEEN - Romans 8:25 But if we hope for that we see not, then do we with patience wait for it. KJV**

- * **WE THROUGH PATIENCE AND COMFORT OF THE SCRIPTURES**

Romans 15:4 For whatsoever things were written aforetime were written for our learning, that we through patience and comfort of the scriptures might have hope. KJV

- * **THE SIGNS OF A TRUE APOSTLE – PATIENCE - 2 Corinthians 12:12 Truly the signs of an apostle were wrought among you in all patience, in signs, and wonders, and mighty deeds. KJV**

- * **FOLLOW AFTER – PATIENCE - 1 Timothy 6:11 But thou, O man of God, flee these things; and follow after righteousness, godliness, faith, love, patience, meekness. KJV**

- * **CHURCHES DISPLAYING PATIENCE - 2 Thessalonians 1:4**

4 So that we ourselves glory in you in the churches of God for your patience and faith in all your persecutions and tribulations that ye endure: KJV

2 Timothy 3:10 But thou hast fully known my doctrine, manner of life, purpose, faith, longsuffering, charity, patience, KJV

- * **FAITH AND PATIENCE INHERITS GOD'S PROMISES. - Hebrews 6:12 That ye be not slothful, but followers of them who through faith and patience inherit the promises. KJV**

- * **AFTER OBEDIENCE AND PATIENCE, WE RECEIVE THE PROMISE**

Hebrews 10:36 For ye have need of patience, that, after ye have done the will of God, ye might receive the promise. KJV

- * **THE HOLY SPIRIT STRENGTHENING US WITH PATIENCE - Colossians 1:11 Strengthened with all might, according to his glorious power, unto all patience and longsuffering with joyfulness; KJV**

- * **PATIENCE CONTRASTED WITH SELF CONTROL, (temperance).**

There are many times when we need to exercise self-control. but WHEN circumstances ARE beyond our control, we need patience.

- * **ADD TO YOUR TEMPERANCE – PATIENCE 2 Peter 1:6 And to knowledge temperance; and to temperance patience; and to patience godliness; KJV**

- * **WE NEED PATIENCE TO RUN THE RACE SET BEFORE US**

Hebrews 12:1 Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which doth so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us, KJV

- * **BE PATIENT IN WAITING FOR THE LORD'S COMING**

James 5:7 Be patient therefore, brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the earth, and hath long patience for it, until he receive the early and latter rain. KJV

- After taking note of all the scriptures relating to patience and the significant presence of patience within the life of the believer let us truly commit ourselves to “REMAINING UNDER”, that is remaining in a position of faith and trust in God while waiting for his direction,

AMEN – Ps Barry